

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 318

By Campbell

A RESOLUTION to designate March 13 as "Father Charles Strobel Day".

WHEREAS, Father Charles Frederick Strobel was a Nashville native, grew up in the Germantown neighborhood, and fostered deep connections within the community and churches in the area; and

WHEREAS, Father Strobel believed in living his faith on a daily basis, pulling inspiration from the Sermon on the Mount, among other holy texts and divine inspirations; and

WHEREAS, upon becoming a priest, Father Strobel quickly and effectively set his sights on bettering the lives of the homeless and impoverished by opening up a facility for homeless people so they could have a warm place to stay at a time when endemic poverty and other social concerns were impacting Tennessee and the nation as a whole; and

WHEREAS, Father Strobel founded the Room in the Inn, a sanctuary opened in a church parking lot in the winter of 1985; and

WHEREAS, the Room in the Inn has since blossomed into a national model for assisting the homeless, with over 200 congregations and 7,000 volunteers sheltering nearly 1,500 individuals from November 1 to March 31 of each season; and

WHEREAS, this State seeks to honor Father Strobel and how he combated homelessness to enact positive change and created programs for the homeless that have become a successful model for the entire nation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that March 13 is designated as "Father Charles Strobel Day" to honor his mission and the valiant and noble strides Father Charles Frederick Strobel

took to combat homelessness in Tennessee and the positive impact his efforts have had nationwide.